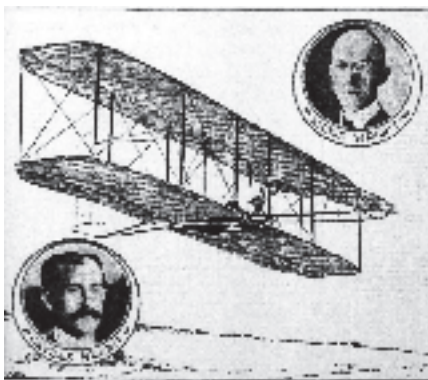


developments in the aviation sector. Countries competed with each other to one-up the others' sophisticated developments, with the British developing the airplane-detecting radar followed by the Germans developing radio wave navigation techniques. Fighter jets, advanced landing systems and high altitude aircrafts followed.



In 1947, US Air Force Pilot Captain Charles Yeager broke the sound barrier in the first supersonic flight becoming the fastest man alive.

Commercial flights started not long after and now, well, an airplane makes a landing somewhere around the world every three seconds!

Air travel is considered to be the safest form of travel in the world. A funny but true fact reveals that donkeys kill more people annually than plane crashes. In spite of these phenomenal odds, 80% of the population of the world has Aerophobia, viz fear of flying. In some (5%) this fear is so intense that they abandon flights and opt for other modes of transport.

We've come a long way since 1903. In fact the wingspan of a Boeing 747 is longer than the Wright brothers' first flight! The world today would be crippled without the discovery of flight. Businesses would crash, economies would slow down, worse still, holidays would be cancelled!

Alloys

An Alloy is a combination of two or more elements to form a metallic solid solution. It's an impure substance formed by two or more pure or semi-pure substances. It is the impurities that add the desired characteristics to the alloy.

The discovery of alloys dates back to prehistoric times when man discovered that iron could be strengthened with the addition of carbon to create wrought iron and copper and tin could be combined to make bronze. This was the beginning of the Bronze Age with stronger weapons, sturdier utensils and shinier jewellery.

Alloys are essential to all fields – construction, transportation, medicine,